

GravelKing Pro

GravelKing Pro — Financial Evaluation (Bootstrapped Model)

September 2026 · All figures are MODEL ASSUMPTIONS for planning, clearly labeled — not actuals. Replace assumptions with live Stripe/Play data as it accumulates.

1. Revenue Streams

Stream	Price	Notes
Pro subscription	\$9.99/mo	Core tier; mastering + generation
King subscription	\$24.99/mo	Unlimited + certificates + forensics
Certificate unlock	\$1.99/track	One-off; expected attach on 25-40% of finished songs
Referral commissions	—%	Cost of acquisition, paid only on verified paid invoices

Blended ARPU assumption: \$11.50/mo (85% Pro, 15% King mix + certificate attach ≈ \$0.60/user/mo).

2. Unit Economics (per paying user, monthly)

Cost line	Est. cost	Basis
Vertex Gemini (JAX chat)	\$0.05-0.15	~2K tokens/prompt, ~30 prompts/user
ElevenLabs (voice/music)	\$0.40-0.90	plan quota amortized
Lyria composition	\$0.30-0.60	~2 compositions/user
MLK mastering compute	\$0.05-0.20	CPU worker, minutes/track
Storage + bandwidth	\$0.10-0.25	WAV/MP3 vault
Stripe/Play fees	~\$0.60 (Pro) / ~\$1.00 (King)	2.9%+\$0.30 / Play 15-30%
Total variable cost	≈ \$1.50-2.70	
Gross margin	≈ 77-87%	healthy SaaS range

3. Fixed Costs (monthly, bootstrapped)

Item	Est.
Replit hosting (production)	\$25-100
Vertex/GCP base + domain + misc	\$20-60

Item	Est.
ElevenLabs plan base	\$5-22
Email/tools/misc	\$10-30
Total fixed	≈ \$60-210/mo

4. Break-Even

At \$11.50 ARPU and ~\$9 contribution margin per subscriber: - **Break-even ≈ 10-25 paying subscribers** on fixed costs alone. - **Sustainable operating point (covering founder time at token \$2K/mo): ~350 paying subscribers ≈ \$4,000 MRR.**

5. 24-Month Bootstrapped Scenarios

Assumptions: organic-led growth (see Bootstrap Workflow), 3% visitor→signup, 4% signup→paid (industry 2-5%), 6% monthly churn, referral k-factor 0.15 after month 4.

Scenario	Mo 6 subs	Mo 12 subs	Mo 24 subs	Mo 24 MRR
Conservative	60	220	800	~\$9,200
Base	120	520	2,400	~\$27,600
Breakout (1-2 viral videos/mo)	300	1,500	8,000	~\$92,000

Certificate one-offs add ~5-8% on top of subscription revenue in all scenarios.

6. Cash Needs (Bootstrapped)

Phase	Spend	Purpose
Now → launch	<\$500	Already built; domain, hosting live
Launch → 500 subs	\$100-300/mo	Hosting scale-up, occasional boosted posts (\$5/day tests)
500+ subs	Self-funding	Reinvest 30% of MRR into content + referral payouts

No outside capital required. The only irreplaceable asset already exists: the platform, the kernel, and the certificate system.

7. Key Risks & Hedges

Risk	Hedge
LLM/music API price spikes	Usage quotas per tier; costs capped by plan limits
Platform dependency (Play/Stripe)	Dual rails already live (web Stripe + Play Billing)
Certificate legal challenge	Conservative claims in copy (“evidence of account activity”), notarized-style audit trail

Risk

Churn after novelty

Hedge

Song vault + certificate portfolio =
switching cost

8. Verdict

The model works at bootstrap scale because variable costs are pennies, fixed costs are hundreds, and the product's most emotional feature (the certificate) is also its highest-margin one. The binding constraint is **attention, not money** — which is why the growth workflow (Document 04) and the 14-day content pack (Document 05) are the real operating plan.